

★ = high chance of appearing (ranked against past IBPS PO Mains papers and 2026 bank exams). Each answer is followed by the key fact and its source. Marking: +1.2 right, -0.30 wrong.

1. In July 2026, RBI approved Mahesh Muralidhar Pai, a Chief General Manager at Canara Bank, as MD & CEO of which private sector bank for three years? ★

Ans (A) South Indian Bank

RBI's letter of 7 Jul 2026 approved Pai as South Indian Bank MD & CEO for 3 years from 1 Oct 2026 (Business Standard, 8 Jul 2026).

2. In tie-ups reported on 1 July 2026, NPCI partnered with which two banks to offer real-time foreign exchange rates and settlement for UPI payments made by Indians travelling abroad?

Ans (A) HSBC India and J.P. Morgan Payments

NPCI signed separate tie-ups with HSBC India and J.P. Morgan Payments to provide real-time FX via API integration for cross-border UPI (J.P. Morgan release, 30 Jun 2026; Business Standard, 1 Jul 2026).

3. Which Indian bank received its first international issuer credit rating, 'BBB-/Stable' (investment grade), from S&P Global Ratings in July 2026?

Ans (B) Federal Bank

S&P gave Federal Bank an inaugural BBB-/Stable long-term and A-3 short-term issuer rating (Business Standard, 9 Jul 2026).

4. RBI issued its Cybersecurity, Technology: Risk, Resilience and Assurance Framework Directions, 2026 on 31 July 2026. Within how many hours of detection must regulated entities report a cyber incident to RBI through the DAKSH platform? ★

Ans (D) 6 hours

The directions (seven parallel sets, one per entity class, issued 31 Jul 2026) require cyber incidents to be reported within 6 hours of detection on RBI's DAKSH platform, with CERT-In also notified (KPMG India, Sep 2026; DSCI brief).

5. In July 2026, NPCI raised the per-transaction limit for approving UPI payments with on-device biometrics (fingerprint or face) instead of the UPI PIN. What is the new limit? ★

Ans (A) ₹10,000

NPCI circular OC-226A of 3 Jul 2026 raised the biometric limit from ₹5,000 to ₹10,000 per transaction, effective 7 Aug 2026 (NPCI circular; news reports, Jul 2026).

6. In its World Economic Outlook Update of July 2026, what did the IMF project as India's GDP growth for FY2026-27?

Ans (A) 6.4%

The IMF trimmed India's FY27 forecast to 6.4% from 6.5% in April and raised FY28 to 6.7% (IMF WEO Update, 8 Jul 2026; Business Today / DD India).

7. According to MoSPI data released on 13 July 2026, what was India's all-India CPI-based retail inflation for June 2026?

Ans (A) 4.38%

June 2026 CPI inflation (base 2024=100) was 4.38%, up from 3.93% in May; food inflation was 5.32% and rural inflation 4.74% (MoSPI press release, 13 Jul 2026).

8. MoSPI released India's first-ever Index of Services Production (ISP) in July 2026. What is its base year? ★

Ans (A) 2024-25

The trial ISP has base year 2024-25 and covers 19 formal service sub-sectors (~60% of services); the first release, for April 2026, came on 14 Jul 2026 (PIB / MoSPI, Jul 2026).

9. On 15 July 2026, what outlay did the Union Cabinet approve for India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0? ★

Ans (A) About ₹1.27 lakh crore

The Cabinet approved ISM 2.0 with about ₹1.27 lakh crore (vs ₹76,000 crore for ISM 1.0); the same day it cleared phase 2 of the mobile phone manufacturing scheme at ₹62,500 crore (Business Standard, 15 Jul 2026).

10. PM Modi launched the Modified UDAN scheme at Jodhpur on 4 July 2026. It runs from FY2026-27 to FY2035-36. What is its total outlay? ★

Ans (B) ₹28,840 crore

Modified UDAN has ₹28,840 crore over 10 years and targets 100 new aerodromes and 200 helipads (Cabinet approval, 25 Mar 2026; Business Standard, 4 Jul 2026).

11. Which state topped NITI Aayog's first-ever Investment Friendliness Index (IFI) 2026, released in July 2026? ★

Ans (A) Gujarat

Gujarat ranked first with 56.6, ahead of Maharashtra (53.7) and Tamil Nadu (53.3); the index uses 84 indicators across eight pillars (NITI Aayog; Drishti IAS, Jul 2026).

12. The Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath was added to the UNESCO World Heritage List in July 2026. What number World Heritage Site is it for India?

Ans (D) 45th

Sarnath was inscribed on 25 Jul 2026 at the 48th World Heritage Committee session in Busan, Republic of Korea, making it India's 45th site (UNESCO / PIB, Jul 2026).

13. In July 2026, PM Narendra Modi became the second Indian PM after Jawaharlal Nehru to receive the 'Bintang Adipurna'. Which country's highest state honour is it?

Ans (B) Indonesia

President Prabowo Subianto conferred the Bintang Republik Indonesia Adipurna on Modi in Jakarta on 7 Jul 2026 (Indonesian State Secretariat / Tempo, Jul 2026).

14. On which date did the India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) and the Double Contribution Convention enter into force?

Ans (D) 15 July 2026

Both came into force on 15 Jul 2026; CETA was signed on 24 Jul 2025 and the DCC on 10 Feb 2026 (PIB, Jul 2026).

15. DRDO flight-tested 'Kusha' for the first time on 23 July 2026 from Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha. What kind of weapon is it?

Ans (B) Long-range surface-to-air missile

Kusha is an indigenous long-range surface-to-air missile (LR-SAM), part of the layered air defence envisaged under Mission Sudarshan Chakra (MoD / Business Today, 23-24 Jul 2026).